

POL40970 - The Politics of European Governance

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Term 2



Introduction

The European Union (EU) currently consists of 27 European countries. It has evolved into a political community that deeply affects the daily lives of its citizens. How can we explain the process of European Integration? What does the political structure of the EU look like? The module surveys the development of European integration and introduces students to the EU's political system. We will discuss theories of European integration and examine major challenges, that the EU faces at the beginning of the 21st century. The module is research lead, in that it focuses upon the political science literature that seeks to explain various aspects of European integration. This is reflected in the extensive reading list provided with the module.

The module is aimed at those wanting a full and detailed introduction to (1) the history and theories of European integration; (2) the political institutions of the EU and its policy-making process; and (3) current and future challenges facing the EU as a political system. The module does not assume any prior knowledge of the EU or EU politics.

Module structure

The module follows the seminar format. This means that in general students will be responsible for directing individual class sessions. It also means that the module requires you to read a considerable amount of material, think about what you have read, and regularly talk about your understanding of the readings. Each week different student groups will lead the discussion by preparing a presentation to introduce the topic to their peers and run the seminar for the 1st hour. A peer-review exercise will help students develop the drafts of their research papers, and a final group project will constitute the end of module assessment. More details on assessment requirements are provided below.

Learning outcomes

At the end of this module students will be able to:

- Explain the historical development of the European integration project from its beginnings as the European Coal and Steel Community to the institution we currently see today.
- Explain how the three main legislative institutions of the EU function together and produce policy.
- Analyse European integration using different theoretical approaches.
- Discuss different EU policy areas and the manner in which the EU functions in these areas.
- Explain key concepts about integration to others both verbally and in writing.
- Discuss the current and future challenges facing the EU in light of the theories discussed throughout the module.

Module assessment

Module grading scheme

- Running a seminar: 25% (includes outline & materials)
- Project development plan and peer-review work: 25%
- Project implementation and report: 50%

Student-led seminar

Students will be required to lead discussion as part of a group once during the semester (preparation of handouts and/or overheads recommended). Presentations will relate to the seminar topics for a particular week, and topics will be assigned at the beginning of the term.

Project development plan and peer review

Students will prepare a project development plan for the VAA-related project they plan to implement. The aim of the project development plan is to explain the challenge(s) the project aims to address and the approaches that will be used to address this. What this looks like in practice depends somewhat on the project they develop and the audience they are targeting. The plan should include:

- **Scope Definition:** Explain how you intend to compliment the core VAA project and provide an in-depth exploration of the nature of the problem(s) to be addressed by these efforts. Ensure the project balances narrow focus for depth and broadness for creativity.
- **Goal and Timeline Setting:** Establish realistic objectives and timelines aligned with the project's scope and resources. Include a GANTT Chart describing the timeline and key milestones.
- **Resource Allocation:** Determine necessary resources (human, material) and allocate them effectively.
- **Accountability mechanisms:** How will the team ensure each member delivers the tasks on time and to the required level of quality?
- **Risk Management:** Identify potential risks and develop mitigation strategies.
- **Communication Strategy:** Establish regular, transparent communication channels for team updates and feedback.
- **Feedback and Adaptation:** Encourage open feedback and be prepared to make iterative changes based on ongoing learning and results.

The peer review process is central to publishing work in academia. Part of your assessment for this module will therefore involve peer reviewing one each others' work. Students will be required to submit a first draft of their group VAA project proposal on **21 March 2024**. The draft essays will then be distributed for peer review. Each student

is required to write a review of two papers. These reviews are due on **27 March 2024** and are graded by the instructor and then returned to the authors. The advantage of this approach is that students can use these reviews to improve their work when redrafting their final research paper for submission. A full set of peer-review guidelines will be distributed before this exercise.

Through this process you will:

- Learn how to carefully read a piece of writing, with attention to the details of the piece in terms of structure and content (whether the piece is your own or another writer's);
- Learn how to strengthen your writing by taking into account the responses of actual and anticipated readers;
- Make the transition from writing primarily for yourselves or for an instructor to writing for a broader audience
- Learn how to formulate and communicate constructive feedback on a peer's work;
- Learn how to gather and respond to feedback on your own work.

Project implementation and report

Your contribution to project implementation is assessed through your contributions to shared planning documents and Miro boards supporting project development. At the end of the VAA project a project report should be submitted by each student. The report should include the following sections and be no longer than 3000 words

1. Cover page with project title and student ID
2. Project objectives:
 - What was the overall purpose of the VAA project and the extensions implemented?
 - What were you trying to achieve and/or what difference were you trying to make?
3. Creativity:
 - What were the novel aspects of the VAA project? How did your group go beyond the basic VAA app to extend the reach of the project?
4. Increasing engagement:
 - Context - What needs and/or opportunities did your project address and for whom?
 - What was your proposed approach and/or solution?
 - What was the value-added of the project and for whom? What were the benefits of the project?
 - What external barriers or obstacles did you face in undertaking the project?

- Were there any regulatory / institutional requirements to which you had to adhere?
- What personal or internal barriers might you face in implementing the project?
- What were the risks associated with the chosen approach?
- How did you pilot / prototype / test your proposed solution?

5. Success:

- What was the vision for the project?
- How did you measure success and/or show evidence of the outcomes

6. Feedback and support:

- Who were the key people/ resources, inside or outside your organisation, who offered you support and helped you to overcome the obstacles/barriers?

7. Sharing learning

- How did you share your new approach and lessons learnt with your colleagues, peers and the wider community?

Important dates

- **21 March 2024:** VAA Project proposal due
- **27 March 2024:** Peer-review assignment due
- **14 May 2024:** Project implementation report due

Grading Criteria

In essence, markers assess four crucial elements in any assignment:

- Analysis/understanding
- Extent and use of reading
- Organisation/structure
- Writing proficiency

The various grades/classifications reflect the extent to which an answer displays essential features of each of these elements (and their relative weighting). At its simplest: the better the analysis, the wider the range of appropriate sources consulted, the greater the understanding of the materials read, the clearer the writing style, and the more structured the argument, the higher will be the mark.

The following provides an indicative outline of the criteria used by markers to award a particular grade/classification. If you are in any confusion about how to correctly approach referencing and bibliography issues, there are many good guides available online (Here for instance: <http://www.ucd.ie/t4cms/Guide69.pdf>). Proper referencing is ESSENTIAL in a good assignment.

Grade explanation

Grade: A

Excellent Performance

A deep and systematic engagement with the assessment task, with consistently impressive demonstration of a comprehensive mastery of the subject matter, reflecting:

- A deep and broad knowledge and critical insight as well as extensive reading;
- A critical and comprehensive appreciation of the relevant literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework
- An exceptional ability to organise, analyse and present arguments fluently and lucidly with a high level of critical analysis, amply supported by evidence, citation or quotation;
- A highly-developed capacity for original, creative and logical thinking
- An extensive and detailed knowledge of the subject matter
- A highly-developed ability to apply this knowledge to the task set
- Evidence of extensive background reading
- Clear, fluent, stimulating and original expression
- Excellent presentation (spelling, grammar, graphical) with minimal or no presentation errors
- Referencing style consistently executed in recognised style

Grade: B

Very Good Performance

A thorough and well organised response to the assessment task, demonstrating:

- A thorough familiarity with the relevant literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework
- Well-developed capacity to analyse issues, organise material, present arguments clearly and cogently well supported by evidence, citation or quotation;
- Some original insights and capacity for creative and logical thinking
- A broad knowledge of the subject matter
- Considerable strength in applying that knowledge to the task set
- Evidence of substantial background reading
- Clear and fluent expression
- Quality presentation with few presentation errors
- Referencing style for the most part consistently executed in recognised style

Grade: C

Good Performance

An intellectually competent and factually sound answer with, marked by:

- Evidence of a reasonable familiarity with the relevant literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework
- Good developed arguments, but more statements of ideas
- Arguments or statements adequately but not well supported by evidence, citation or quotation
- Some critical awareness and analytical qualities
- Some evidence of capacity for original and logical thinking
- Adequate but not complete knowledge of the subject matter
- Omission of some important subject matter or the appearance of several minor errors
- Capacity to apply knowledge appropriately to the task albeit with some errors
- Evidence of some background reading
- Clear expression with few areas of confusion
- Writing of sufficient quality to convey meaning but some lack of fluency and command of suitable vocabulary
- Good presentation with some presentation errors
- Referencing style executed in recognised style, but with some errors

Grade: D

Satisfactory Performance

An acceptable level of intellectual engagement with the assessment task showing:

- Some familiarity with the relevant literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework
- Mostly statements of ideas, with limited development of argument
- Limited use of evidence, citation or quotation
- Limited critical awareness displayed
- Limited evidence of capacity for original and logical thinking
- Basic grasp of subject matter, but somewhat lacking in focus and structure
- Main points covered but insufficient detail

- Some effort to apply knowledge to the task but only a basic capacity or understanding displayed
- Little or no evidence of background reading
- Several minor errors or one major error
- Satisfactory presentation with an acceptable level of presentation errors
- Referencing style inconsistent

Grade: D-

Acceptable

The minimum acceptable of intellectual engagement with the assessment task which:

- The minimum acceptable appreciation of the relevant literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework
- Ideas largely expressed as statements, with little or no developed or structured argument
- Minimum acceptable use of evidence, citation or quotation
- Little or no analysis or critical awareness displayed or is only partially successful
- Little or no demonstrated capacity for original and logical thinking
- Shows a basic grasp of subject matter but may be poorly focussed or badly structured or contain irrelevant material
- Has one major error and some minor errors
- Demonstrates the capacity to complete only moderately difficult tasks related to the subject material
- No evidence of background reading
- Displays the minimum acceptable standard of presentation (spelling, grammar, graphical)
- Referencing inconsistent with major errors

Grade: E

Fail (marginal)

A factually sound answer with a partially successful, but not entirely acceptable, attempt to:

- Integrate factual knowledge into a broader literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework develop arguments
- Support ideas or arguments with evidence, citation or quotation

- Engages with the subject matter or problem set, despite major deficiencies in structure, relevance or focus
- Has two major error and some minor errors
- Demonstrates the capacity to complete only part of, or the simpler elements of, the task
- An incomplete or rushed answer e.g. the use of bullet points through part / all of answer
- Little or no referencing style evident

Grade: F

Fail (unacceptable)

An unacceptable level of intellectual engagement with the assessment task, with:

- No appreciation of the relevant literature or theoretical, technical or professional framework
- No developed or structured argument
- No use of evidence, citation or quotation
- No analysis or critical awareness displayed or is only partially successful
- No demonstrated capacity for original and logical thinking
- A failure to address the question resulting in a largely irrelevant answer or material of marginal relevance predominating
- A display of some knowledge of material relative to the question posed, but with very serious omissions / errors and/or major inaccuracies included in answer
- Solutions offered to a very limited portion of the problem set
- An answer unacceptably incomplete (e.g. for lack of time)
- A random and undisciplined development, layout or presentation
- Unacceptable standards of presentation, such as grammar, spelling or graphical presentation
- Evidence of substantial plagiarism
- No referencing style evident

Grade: G

Fail (wholly unacceptable)

No intellectual engagement with the assessment task

- Complete failure to address the question resulting in an entirely irrelevant answer
- Little or no knowledge displayed relative to the question posed
- Little or no solution offered for the problem set
- Evidence of extensive plagiarism
- No referencing style evident

Grade: NG

No grade (no work was submitted by the student or student was absent from the assessment, or work submitted did not merit a grade).

Extenuating circumstances

In the case that a student will not be able to meet an assessment deadline or will be absent from the course for an extended period of time, and this is known **IN ADVANCE**, they should consult the UCD policies on extenuating circumstances found here:

<http://www.ucd.ie/students/studentdesk/extenuating.html>.

It is important that in such cases you make the issue known to the lecturer as soon as possible. The sooner that the lecturer is made aware of the situation, the more likely it is that you can be accommodated.

Late assignment submissions

If a student submits an assignment late, the following penalties will be applied:

- Coursework received at any time within two weeks of the due date will be graded, but a penalty will apply.
 - Coursework submitted at any time up to one week after the due date will have the grade awarded reduced by two grade points (for example, from B- to C).
 - Coursework submitted more than one week but up to two weeks after the due date will have the grade reduced by four grade points (for example, from B- to D+). Where a student finds they have missed a deadline for submission, they should be advised that they may use the remainder of the week to improve their submission without additional penalty.
- Coursework received more than two weeks after the due date will not be accepted.

Plagiarism

The university policy on plagiarism can be found here:

<https://www.ucd.ie/governance/resources/policypage-plagiarismpolicy/>

Plagiarism is taken extremely seriously throughout the university and academia in general. The school has systems in place to detect plagiarism and these systems are fully implemented. You need to be very clear about what constitutes plagiarism and avoid it at all costs. The library has a good guide to help you avoid plagiarism that can be found here:

<https://libguides.ucd.ie/academicintegrity/plagiarismandwriting>

Any student caught plagiarising will be subject to penalties in accordance with university policy.

Module readings

Required Readings:

The following text shall be used extensively throughout the module, so it is recommended that it is purchased:

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. 6th Edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Further reading:

In addition to the readings required for each topic, a series of recommended readings are also included in the syllabus. These readings will generally not be discussed in class, but are useful for those who wish to explore a particular topic in more detail. They will also be very useful when approaching the essay assignment, for which you are required to demonstrate a more in-depth understanding of your chosen topic.

The following are good general texts on the EU and EU politics.

- Nugent, N. (2006). *Government and Politics of the European Union*. 6th ed. Duke University Press.
- Peterson, J. & Bomberg, E. (1999). *Decision-Making in the European Union*. New York: St. Martin's Press.
- Peterson, J. & Shackleton, M. (2006). *The Institutions of the European Union*. 2nd ed. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Richardson, J. (2005). *European Union: Power and Policy-Making*. 3rd ed. London: Routledge.
- Bache, I. & George, S. (2006). *Politics in the European Union*. 2nd ed. New York: Oxford University Press.

- Moravcsik, A. (1998). *The Choice for Europe*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press.
- Rosamond, B. (2000). *Theories of European Integration*. New York: St. Martin's Press.
- Cini, M. & Bourne, A.K. (2006). *Palgrave Advances in European Union Studies*. New York: Palgrave.
- Jorgensen, K.E., Pollack, M.A., & Rosamond, B. (2007). *The Handbook of European Union Politics*. New York: Sage Publications.

In addition to these readings, students should keep up to date on current European affairs by reading daily newspapers, or one of the many websites devoted to EU politics. These websites include the following:

- <http://www.euobserver.com>
- <http://europa.eu.int>
- <http://www.eupolitics.com>
- <http://www.ft.com>
- <http://blogs.lse.ac.uk/euoppblog/>
- <http://blogs.lse.ac.uk/brexit/>

Finally, each week a number of study questions are provided in order to guide your thinking about the topics being discussed and the required readings. These study questions will form the basis of the seminar topics covered and so careful consideration of the issues they raise should help you get to grasp with the issues being dealt with.

WEEKLY READING LIST

PART I: THE HISTORY AND THEORIES OF EUROPEAN INTEGRATION

Week 1: The Origins of the EU, and the development of Integration Theory.

Study question

- What are the main milestones that the integration process in Europe went through? How has the European integration project developed over time and how has the policy remit of the EU evolved?
- Why did neofunctionalists like Ernst Haas believe that the process of European integration, having begun so modestly, would snowball into an ongoing process of political integration? Are you convinced by the idea of spill-over effects proposed by the neofunctionalists as an explanation of the integration process?

- By the late 1950s, the neofunctionalist spill-over processes predicted by Ernst Haas seemed to be in full swing, only to be disrupted in the 1960s by French President Charles de Gaulle. Looking beyond the personality of de Gaulle, (1) analyze why the decades of the 1960s and 1970s appeared to have falsified Haas' neofunctionalism, and (2) assess whether the 1960s and 1970s were a period of progress, or rollback, or a mix of the two, in the integration process.
- Many saw the Single European Act (SEA) to be an effort to reinvigorate the integration process after several decades of stagnation, but the explanations for the SEA found in the required readings differ. What are the differences between the respective explanations for the SEA put forward by Zysman and Sandholtz and Moravcsik. Which argument is more persuasive, and why?
- Brexit is the first example of a member state trying to leave the EU. Can the existing theories of European integration shed light on the Brexit process and any likely outcomes?

Required Readings

- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2011. The political system of the European Union. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 1.
- Schmitter, P.C. (2006). Ernst B. Haas and the legacy of neofunctionalism. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 12(2): 255-272.
- Stone Sweet, A. & Sandholtz, W. (1997). European Integration and Supranational Governance. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 4(3): 297-317.
- Moravcsik, A. (1998). *The Choice for Europe*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press. Chapter 1.

Further reading

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. 6th Edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapters 4 and 5.
- Jones, E., Kelemen, R.D. and Meunier, S. 2016. Failing forward? The Euro crisis and the incomplete nature of European integration. *Comparative Political Studies*, 49(7), pp.1010-1034.
- Marks, G. (2011). Europe and Its Empires: From Rome to the European Union. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 50(1): 1-20.
- Haas, E.B. (1958). *The Uniting of Europe*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.
- Hoffmann, S. (1966). Obstinate or Obsolete? The Fate of the Nation-State and the Case of Western Europe. *Daedalus*. 95(3).
- Deutsch, K.W. et al. (1957). *Political Community in the North Atlantic Area: International Organization in the Light of Historical Experience*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.

- Diebold, W. (1959). *The Schuman Plan: A Study in Economic Cooperation, 1950-1959*. New York: Praeger.
- Haas, E.B. (1976). Turbulent Fields and the Theory of Regional Integration. *International Organization*. 30: 173-212.
- Monnet, J. (1978). *Memoirs*. New York: Doubleday.
- Moravcsik, A. *The Choice for Europe*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press. Chapter 2.
- Pollack, M.A. 2003. The Engines of European Integration: Delegation, Agency and Agenda Setting in the EU. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Pollock, M.A. 2005. Theorizing the EU: International Organization, Domestic Polity, or Experiment in New Governance? *Annual Review Political Science*. 8, pp.357-98.
- Rittberger, B. (2001). Which Institutions for Post-War Europe? Explaining the Institutional Design of Europe's First Community. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 8(5): 673-708.
- Caporaso, J. (1998). Regional integration theory: understanding our past and anticipating our future. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 5(1): 1-16.
- Mattli, W. (1999). Explaining regional integration outcomes. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 6(1): 1-27.
- Risse, T. (2005). Neofunctionalism, European identity, and the puzzles of European integration. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 12(2): 291-309.
- Corbett, R. (1987). The 1985 Intergovernmental Conference and the Single European Act. in Roy Pryce (ed.), *The Dynamics of European Union*. New York: Croom Helm.
- Tranholm-Mikkelsen, J. (1991). Neofunctionalism: Obstinate or Obsolete? *Journal of International Studies*. 20(1): 1-22.
- Moravcsik, A. (1993). Preferences and Power in the European Community: A Liberal Intergovernmentalist Approach. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 31: 473-524.
- Bickerton, C.J., Hodson, D. and Puetter, U. 2014. The new intergovernmentalism: European integration in the post-Maastricht era. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.703-22.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015a. What's the news in 'new intergovernmentalism'? A critique of Bickerton, Hodson and Puetter. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.723-30.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015. Liberal intergovernmentalism and the euro area crisis. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(2), pp.177-195.

- Puetter, U. 2016. The centrality of consensus and deliberation in contemporary EU politics and the new intergovernmentalism. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.601-615.
- Puetter, U. and Fabbrini, S. 2016. Catalysts of integration—the role of core intergovernmental forums in EU politics. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.633-642.
- Kleine, M., and Pollack, M. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Its Critics. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1493–1509.
- Moravcsik, A. 2018. Preferences, Power and Institutions in 21st-century Europe. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1648-1674.
- Meunier, S., and Vachudova, M. A. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism, Illiberalism and the Potential Superpower of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1631–1647.
- Hix, S. 2018. When Optimism Fails: Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Citizen Representation. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1595–1613.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and the Crises of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1578–1594.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. European integration (theory) in times of crisis. A comparison of the Euro and Schengen crises, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(7), pp.969-989
- Schmidt, V. A. 2018. Rethinking EU Governance: From Old to New Approaches to Who Steers Integration. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1544–1561.
- Naurin, D. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism in the Councils of the EU: A Baseline Theory?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1526–1543.
- McNamara, K. R. 2018. Authority Under Construction: The European Union in Comparative Political Perspective. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1510–1525.
- Jones, E. 2018. Towards a theory of disintegration, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(3), pp.440-451.
- Rauh, C., 2019. Between neo-functionalist optimism and post-functionalist pessimism: Integrating politicisation into integration theory. Working paper.
- Genschel, P. and Jachtenfuchs, M., 2018. From market integration to core state powers: the Eurozone crisis, the refugee crisis and integration theory. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56(1), pp.178-196.

Week 2: Institutional change and Institutionalism

Study Questions

1. While the neofunctionalist-intergovernmentalist debate enlightened our understanding of the integration process, new theories of EU politics have since emerged focusing on institutions. What are these theories and what types of questions do they attempt to address?
2. How has the focus of the theoretical debate changed in light of these new institutionalist theories?
3. What do the different 'institutionalism' have in common and how do they differ?

Required Reading

- Aspinwall, M.D. & Schneider, G. (2000). Same menu, separate tables: The institutionalist turn in political science and the study of European integration. *European Journal of Political Research*. 38(1): 1–36.
- Tsebelis, G. & Garrett, G. (2001) The Institutional Foundations of Intergovernmentalism and Supranationalism. *International Organization*. 55(2): 357-90.
- Pierson, P. (1996). The Path to European Integration: A Historical Institutional Analysis. *Comparative Political Studies*. 29(2): 123-163.
- Checkel, J.T. & Moravcsik, M. (2001). A Constructivist Research Programme in EU Studies? *European Union Politics*. 2(2): 219-49.

Further reading

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. 6th Edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 6.
- Moravcsik, A. & Nicolaidis, K. (1998). Explaining the Treaty of Amsterdam: Interests, Influence, Institutions. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 37: 59–85.
- Garrett, G. & Tsebelis, G. (1996). An Institutional Critique of Intergovernmentalism. *International Organization*. 50(02): 269–99.
- Hix, S. (1994). The Study of the European Community: The Challenge to Comparative Politics. *West European Politics*. 17: 1-30.
- Garrett, G. & Tsebelis, G. (1996). An Institutional Critique of Intergovernmentalism. *International Organization*. Vol. 50, No. 2, pp. 269-99.
- Christiansen, T., Jorgensen, K.E. & Wiener, A. (1999). The Social Construction of Europe. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 6: 528-44.
- Moravcsik, A. (1999). Is Something Rotten in the State of Denmark? Constructivism and European Integration. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 6(4).
- Checkel, J.T. & Moravcsik, A. (2001). A Constructivist Research Programme in EU Studies? *European Union Politics*. 2(2): 219-49.

- Jupille, J. & Caporaso, J.A. (1999). Institutionalism and the European Union: Beyond International Relations and Comparative Politics. *Annual Review of Political Science*. 2: 429–44.
- Aspinwall, M. & Schneider, G. eds. (2000). *The Rules of Integration: Institutional Approaches to the Study of Europe*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.

PART II: THE POLITICAL INSTITUTIONS OF THE EU AND ITS POLICY-MAKING PROCESS

Week 3: Negotiating the treaties

Study questions

- What are the sources of states' bargaining power during treaty negotiations? How do domestic constraints condition states' bargaining strength at IGCs?
- There is conflicting evidence regarding which players and what factors are most likely to affect the outcome of a treaty. What is the role of supranational actors in explaining IGC bargains?
- How has the Treaty of Lisbon shifted the EU's institutional balance of power between the major institutions of the EU?

Required Readings

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 3.
- Dörfler, T., Holzinger, K., & Biesenbender, J. (2017). Constitutional Dynamics in the European Union: Success, Failure, and Stability of Institutional Treaty Revisions. *International Journal of Public Administration*, 1-13.
- Slapin, J. B. (2008). Bargaining power at Europe's intergovernmental conferences: testing institutional and intergovernmental theories. *International Organization*. 62(01): 131-162.
- Finke, D. (2009). Challenges to intergovernmentalism: an empirical analysis of EU treaty negotiations since Maastricht. *West European Politics*. 32(3): 466-495.

Further reading

- Slapin, J. B. (2006). Who is powerful? Examining preferences and testing sources of bargaining strength at European intergovernmental conferences. *European Union Politics*. 7(1): 51-76.
- Schneider, C. J. (2013). Globalizing electoral politics: Political competence and distributional bargaining in the European Union. *World Politics*, 65(3), 452-490.
- Johansson, K. M. (2016). The role of Europarties in EU treaty reform: Theory and practice. *Acta Politica*, 1-20.

- Panke, D. (2017). Speech is silver, silence is golden? Examining state activity in international negotiations. *The Review of International Organizations*, 12(1), 121-146.
- Finke, D., König, T., Proksch, S.O., & Tsebelis, G. (2012). *Reforming the European Union: realizing the impossible*. New Jersey: Princeton University Press.
- Slapin, J. B. (2009). Exit, voice, and cooperation: Bargaining power in international organizations and federal systems. *Journal of Theoretical Politics*. 21(2): 187-211.
- Finke, D. (2010). *European integration and its limits: intergovernmental conflicts and their domestic origins*. ECPR Press.
- Franchino, F. (2013). Challenges to liberal intergovernmentalism. *European Union Politics*. 14(2): 324-337.
- Finke, D. (2009). Domestic Politics and European Treaty Reform Understanding the Dynamics of Governmental Position-Taking. *European Union Politics*. 10(4): 482-506.
- Reinhard, J., Biesenbender, J., & Holzinger, K. (2014). Do arguments matter? Argumentation and negotiation success at the 1997 Amsterdam Intergovernmental Conference. *European Political Science Review*. 6(02): 283-307.
- Finke, D. (2013). Reforming International Institutions: The Domestic Origins and Conditional Logic of Governmental Reform Preferences. *International Studies Quarterly*. 57(2): 288-302.
- Reinhard, J. (2012). Because we are all Europeans! When do EU Member States use normative arguments?. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 19(9): 1336-1356.

Week 4: The EU as a Political System; the Commission and Executive Politics

Study Questions

1. Why do Member States choose to delegate policy-making powers to the supranational level? What types of problems does such delegation solve and what types of problems arise from the delegation decision?
2. Some recent studies find congruence between the Commission and member states' policy positions suggesting that the Commission might not be "completely independent in the performance of their duties" as specified in the treaty and not quite as supranational as it has been often portrayed. To what can we attribute this policy congruence? i.e., what are some of the key factors that constrain the Commission's independence and condition its policy positions, as identified in the readings?

Required Reading

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Further reading

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Week 5: Legislative Politics & Policy making (The Council of Ministers and the European Parliament)

Study Questions

1. Is the European Parliament a “normal” Parliament? In what sense is it “normal” and in what sense (if any) does it remain unique or sui generis? How has this changed over time as the EU has been reformed?
2. What drives policy outcomes in the Council of Ministers?
3. How is the impact of the Council, Parliament and Commission mediated through the institutional structure and rules of the decision-making process? What factors impact upon a legislative actor's ability to influence legislative outcomes?
4. How successful have the attempts to formally model the legislative process been at predicting legislative outcomes? Is this approach suitable for the task at hand? What aspects of the decision-making process might such models miss?
5. How might informal political arrangements reduce the difficulty associated with reaching agreements under more formal legislative procedures?

Required Reading

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Further reading

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- Kreppel, A. (2001). *The European Parliament and Supranational Party System: A Study in Institutional Development*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
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Week 6: Judicial Politics

The ECJ, Judicial Politics and Compliance Study Question

1. Describe the powers of the ECJ. Do these powers make the ECJ an independent court? What limits (both formal and informal) exist on the powers of the ECJ?
2. What do we mean by the term “judicial activism”? Does the ECJ engage in judicial activism often? How have member states reacted to examples of judicial activism by the ECJ?
3. Carruba et al. and Stone Sweet & Brunell disagree on the extent to which member states can act collectively to constrain the ECJ. Which account of ECJ power and influence is more convincing and why?
4. We observe significant variation in the levels of compliance with EU law both between Member States and over time. What can explain this variation?

Required Readings

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- Zhelyazkova, A. (2013). Complying with EU directives' requirements: the link between EU decision-making and the correct transposition of EU provisions. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 20(5), 702-721.

Further reading

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- Weiler, J.H.H. (2000). *The Constitution of Europe: "Do the New Clothes Have an Emperor?" and Other Essays on European Integration*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Tallberg, J. (2004). *European governance and supranational institutions: making states comply*. Routledge.
- Alter, K. (2010). *The European Court's political power: selected essays*. Oxford University Press.
- Hartlapp, M. (2007). On Enforcement, Management and Persuasion: Different Logics of Implementation Policy in the EU and the ILO*. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 45(3), 653-674.
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- Thomson, R. (2007). Time to Comply: National Responses to Six EU Labour Market Directives Revisited. *West European Politics*. 30(5): 987–1008.
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- Closa, C. 2018. The politics of guarding the Treaties: Commission scrutiny of rule of law compliance, *Journal of European Public Policy*
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- Peritz, L. 2018. Obstructing integration: Domestic politics and the European Court of Justice. *European Union Politics*, 19(3), pp.427–457.
- Hartlapp, M. 2018. Power Shifts via the Judicial Arena: How Annulments Cases between EU Institutions Shape Competence Allocation. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56: pp.1429–1445.

Week 7: EP elections and voter advice applications (VAAs)

Guest lecturer: Dr. Laura Sudulich (University of Essex)

Required Readings

- Trechsel, A.H. & Mair, P. (2011). When Parties (Also) Position Themselves: An Introduction to the EU Profiler. *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*, 8:1, 1-20.
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Further reading

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- Reiljan, A., Kutiyski, Y., Krouwel, A., 2020b. Mapping parties in a multidimensional European political space: A comparative study of the EUvox and euandi party position data sets. *Party Politics* 26, 651–663.

Week 8: Elaborating the VAA project

Seminar plan

- Review project extension ideas
- Vote on preferred option
- Elaborate implementation plan and allocate tasks

Week 9: TBC (Interest representation: Lobbying in Brussels)

Study Question

- Describe the different access point through which lobbyists attempt to influence EU policy making. Do the institutional structures of the Commission, EP, and Council aid or hinder lobbyists in their lobbying attempts?
- What different types of factors have been identified as influencing lobbying success?
- What attempts have been made to regulate EU lobbying? Have these attempts been successful?

Key reading

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- European Commission for Democracy Through Law (Venice Commission). (2013). *Report on the Role of Extra-Institutional Actors in the Democratic System*. Available here: [http://www.venice.coe.int/webforms/documents/default.aspx?pdffile=CDL-AD\(2013\)011-e](http://www.venice.coe.int/webforms/documents/default.aspx?pdffile=CDL-AD(2013)011-e)
- Flöthe, L. and Rasmussen, A., 2018. Public voices in the heavenly chorus? Group type bias and opinion representation. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-19.
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- Marshall, D. (2010) Who to Lobby and When: Institutional Determinants of Interest Group Strategies in European Parliament Committees. *European Union Politics*. 11(4): 553-575.
- Mahoney, C. & Baumgartner, F., (2008). Converging perspectives on interest group research in Europe and America. *West European Politics*. 31(6): 1253–1273.
- Mahoney, C. (2007). Lobbying Success in the United States and the European Union. *Journal of Public Policy*. 27(1): 35-56.
- Beyers, J. (2008) Policy Issues, Organizational Format and the Political Strategies of Interest Organizations. *West European Politics*. 31(6): 1188-1211.
- Beyers, J. & Kerremans, B. (2004). Bureaucrats, Politicians, and Societal Interests: How Is European Policy Making Politicized? *Comparative Political Studies*. 37(10): 1119-1150.
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Week 10: TBC (The EU budget)

Study questions

- What actors and institutions are involved in negotiating the EU budget?
- How are the powers of these actors to shape the EU budget influenced by the institutional rules structuring the budget-making process?
- How has the budget-making process in the EU evolved over time?

Required Readings

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Week 11: TBC (The Democratic Deficit, Democratic Legitimacy and Legislative Transparency)

Study Questions

1. What is the EU's "democratic deficit"? What are the fundamental causes of this deficit, and why is it unlikely to be fixed in the near future? Why does Moravcsik argue that the EU is not particularly "broken" and so should not be "fixed"? Why, finally, do Follesdal & Hix believe that the democratic deficit is more serious than Moravcsik (and another analyst, Giandomenico Majone) thinks, and what do they recommend as to fix the problem? Which view do you find most convincing, and why?
2. The Laeken declaration (2001) states that: "the European project [...] derives its legitimacy from democratic, transparent and efficient institutions". At the same time, transparency is seen by Naurin as a necessary but not sufficient condition for democratic accountability in the European Union. How transparent is the EU in general and the legislative process in particular. Has this changed over time? What are the implications of the current levels of transparency in EU politics for the aforementioned democratic deficit? Finally, can the EU be simultaneously democratic transparent and efficient?

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Week 12: TBC (Brexit, public opinion, and the future of the EU)

Study Questions

1. What drives public opinion about the EU? Can traditional explanations of public opinion help us understand the Brexit vote?

2. The balance of power in the Brexit negotiations is heavily in favour of the EU, why is this? What (if anything) might the UK be able to do to mitigate its disadvantaged bargaining position?
3. What are the implications of Brexit for the future of the EU?

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